2.3 Herbs for Good Health

"Let Medicine be thy food and Let Food be Thy Medicine"

Hippocrates, 400 B.C

Food acts as a therapeutic agent in healing sickness/disease and maintaining health. It allows body to function properly. Points to be kept in mind to maintain health are given below:



▲ Plate 2.6 Medicinal Herbs

Principles of Food and Health

- Solely taking vitamin supplements is not the way to good health. -Use foods rather than supplements to treat and prevent chronic diseases.
- Good nutrition creates good health in all areas of existence.
- Nutrition can substantially control the adverse effects of noxious chemicals.
- Nutrients in right quantities are important for health

2.3.1 Medicinal Value of Herbs

A herb is a plant or plant part used for its scent, flavor or therapeutic properties. Herbal medicines are one type of dietary supplement.

Following Table 2.3 gives therapeutic uses of herbs.

Table 2.3 Medicinal Value of Herbs

Herbs / Therapeutic Uses	
Improves blood circulation, menstrual problems. Relieves kidney pain and used in treating diabetes.	Acts as a tonic for stomach and heart. Used for treating urinary tract infection.
	
▲ Plate 2.7 Curry Leaves	▲ Plate 2.8 Coriander Leaves

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